> Thousands of security forces were deployed to keep the peace at India's banks, where crowds of people had formed jittery, snaking lines in the early morning, desperate to exchange now-useless currency notes... Many people on the street said they were stunned and angry. Brawls broke out in lines outside banks, where many had to stand for hours, uncertain whether the stockpile of bills would run out... Poor migrants to the city said the sudden move had stranded them without enough money to eat.[1]

Government spokespersons were swift to dismiss stories of hardships faced by Indians as 'anecdotal claims'. However, since demonetization touched every single person and household in India, anecdotal evidence of the hardships people had suffered was plentiful. People ask why there were no riots in India, if demonetization was as disruptive as these anecdotal stories seemed to indicate it was.

There are some who believe people were scared to protest, for fear of being branded anti-national or unpatriotic. There were reports of people being abused or beaten up when they spoke against demonetization. An example of this was Lallan Singh Khushwaha, a painter, who was beaten up in southeast Delhi's Jaitpur area. He sustained head injuries. When he criticized the step taken by the government, a person identified as Ashiq verbally abused him. 'When I asked him the reason, he started hitting me and asked how I could criticize the Prime Minister. Soon after, others joined him. I sustained injuries on my head and started bleeding,' said Khushwaha. He said that only when some people intervened, was he spared.[2]

Another explanation was that people simply had no time to protest; everyone was struggling to get enough cash to stay afloat. Also, perhaps there was an element of comparative Schadenfreude in the general public. A feeling of – even if I lose one eye (standing in the queue, loss of wages, etc.) the fat cats will lose two (their ill-gotten millions).

A third explanation is that the generosity and open heartedness of our people helped and sustained those around them. Our family experienced this first hand.

Though we had very little usable cash, we put our faith in God and proceeded on our journey. Co-passengers in the train generously